

EPISODE 10 (SESSION 1)

Walking the Blood Path

PRIMARY TEXT: Genesis 15–17

Silence...

Sometimes God is silent because silence is exactly what we need. Yet, not even Avram was comfortable with God's silence—or with His timing.

God may not tell us the answers. He may not tell us the reason for the waiting or the meaning behind the pain or loss or nothingness that we are feeling. He's asking us to, like Avram, lean into the Story, lean into His arms and let go. To relinquish our control and get going!

Sometimes God is silent because silence is exactly what we need.

If we aren't willing to wait and look back. Or able to take a deep breath and "look up at the sky and count the stars," we begin to lose sight of the Story. And when we lose sight of the Story, chaos is invited into the plot (for *all* the characters).

Genesis 15 begins with Avram questioning God about the promises he hasn't seen fulfilled. *Where are you, God? What are you doing? Or even a subtle, prove it.*

We've all been there before.

Once again we see God meeting His people where they are at, and this terrifies Avram. So God steps into his fear knowing full well that Avram can't follow through on his end of this new covenant—this new promise. God walks through the blood path on Avram's behalf, taking the natural consequences off of Avram and onto himself.

God's promise isn't just about one man, it is about a lineage of people, and a way of life, that will bless the world.

Yet doubt seeps in, and Avram and Sarai do their best to take God's promise into their own hands rather than look back to the stars. Schemes, abuse, and taking advantage of those they were meant to lead and protect.

Yet God adds in another "wrinkle," as Marty says. A wrinkle to point out to Avram, and us, that God's promise isn't just about one man, it is about a lineage of people, a way of life—a covenant—that will bless the world.

So, like any beautiful chiasm does, we are pointed back to the moment where all men—slave or Avraham himself—are laid bare, equal.

A reminder that they were all created in the image of God. A reminder of who Avraham was meant to be. Set apart. Different. Bringing justice and peace. Not division and control.

So when you're met with silence instead of a clear or quick answer, when you're met with silence instead of a sign, don't create the answers or backup plans or escape routes yourself. Instead, embrace the silence, and rest in it. Because God is there with you in the silence, walking through the blood path for you, taking on your pain and every worry, asking you to lean in, let go, and love others.

**God is there
with you in the
silence...**

*I sat on the floor with Jesus today. I told Him all my worries and fears.
I yelled a little, too... in between sobs.
You know what He said?—nothing.*

*He put His arm around me, and I leaned into His side.
He let me talk until there was nothing left to share.
No shade or secrets between us.
And all that was left were tears.
You know what He did?—He stayed right there, crying with me.*

PRAYER

*God,
Time and time again you meet us where we are.
You send us reminders of your love.
You clothe us. Redeem us. Rescue us.
And walk through the blood path for us.
You are the God who sees us—each and every one.*

*Because of you,
I find peace in the unknown.
In the midst of my unanswered questions,
and when I gaze up at the stars,
I'll trust the goodness of the story
and the answers you hold.
Amen*

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 10

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

How could you meditate over these parts of Abraham's story? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

In what ways does your community instill or challenge your ideas on waiting on God in the silence? How might your community seek to bless others together now, rather than wait for a "wrinkle" or sign from God?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from the reminder that they are not alone in the silence? Who needs the reminder to let God lead, and not try to take God's promises into their own hands? How can you model this level of trust and blessing to those around you?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? How are you wrestling with the treasure that lies at the center of this chiasm? About the cultural significance of the blood path? What might this speak to in our current world and culture? The struggle is real—it's good!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*We believe that **if we do our part of creating space for God, He will fill it!** We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all. How does open space represent your openness to God's plan and His promises to you —not just your own plan? Where in life do you need to let go and be okay with the uncomfortable silence? Where have you created space to sit in the silence with God, and just look at the stars? You are a part of this covenant, how might you now let go and get going?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world, and they need the blessings and care of people like you. In what ways could you come alongside young adults to model trusting the Story and giving themselves to God's plan? To show them how to let go, love God, and love others?

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*This may be about what we do at work—but it's also about those we interact with every day. Do we hold so tight to our own plans that we mess up the plot and even hurt others? Do we carry Avraham's covenant to bless the world with us always, or only when it is convenient or safe? The way we manage employees and interact with customers or coworkers or families says a lot about the God we believe in and the promises we hold to. **The work we do every day is sacred. It matters to the Kingdom!** That's what walking the blood path was all about.*